

JAMES RICHARDSON

Manchester, United Kingdom

Email: james.richardson@gmail.com

Phone: +44 7892 445621

LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/jamesrichardson84

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Staff Engineer with 14 years building scalable systems and mentoring teams across fintech and e-commerce. I've spent the last seven years at senior levels designing architecture for platforms handling millions of transactions daily. I enjoy solving hard infrastructure problems and helping engineers grow into leadership roles. Outside work, I'm keen on open source contributions and technical writing.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Staff Engineer

TechVault Solutions

techvault.io

Manchester, United Kingdom

March 2021 - Present

Led architectural redesign of core payment processing system, reducing latency by 47% and enabling handling of 150% more concurrent transactions without scaling infrastructure costs.

Established engineering standards and code review practices across 12-person team, improving deployment frequency from monthly to weekly releases with zero increase in production incidents.

Mentored 6 engineers in progressing to senior roles through structured technical discussions and project ownership opportunities, with 4 successfully promoted within 18 months.

Designed and implemented multi-region failover strategy for database infrastructure, achieving 99.99% uptime SLA and reducing recovery time from 4 hours to 8 minutes.

Senior Software Engineer

Vertex Systems Ltd

vertex-systems.co.uk

Leeds, United Kingdom

June 2017 - February 2021

Architected microservices migration project converting monolithic Ruby application to containerized services on Kubernetes, reducing deployment times from 2 hours to 12 minutes.

Implemented comprehensive observability solution using Prometheus and ELK stack, enabling proactive identification of performance issues and reducing mean time to detection by 65%.

Managed cloud infrastructure optimization initiative on AWS, consolidating services and removing redundant resources, resulting in 38% reduction in monthly cloud spend.

Conducted technical interviews and hiring for engineering team, building diverse team of 8 engineers across backend, frontend, and DevOps specializations.

Software Engineer

DataStream Analytics

datastream.io

Manchester, United Kingdom

August 2010 - May 2017

Built real-time data processing pipeline handling 2 billion events daily using Apache Kafka and Spark, serving analytics dashboards for 400+ enterprise clients.

Developed RESTful APIs and backend services in Java and Python, establishing patterns adopted across the wider engineering organization for consistency and maintainability.

Implemented database optimization strategies reducing query times from seconds to milliseconds for key reporting features, improving customer experience and reducing support tickets by 23%.

Participated in on-call rotation and resolved production incidents, documenting lessons learned and implementing preventative monitoring alerts to reduce recurrence of issues.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

University of Manchester

Manchester, United Kingdom

Graduated June 2010

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Java, Python, Go, SQL, Bash

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, MongoDB, Redis, DynamoDB

Cloud and Infrastructure: AWS, Kubernetes, Docker, Terraform, CloudFormation

Messaging and Streaming: Apache Kafka, RabbitMQ, AWS SQS

Monitoring and Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, ELK Stack, DataDog

Tools and Platforms: Git, Jenkins, GitHub Actions, Linux, gRPC

Architecture: Microservices, RESTful APIs, Event-driven systems, System design